

Emergency Operations Plan: Hurricane and Flood Annex (Excerpt)

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Excerpt from the 2026 Emergency Operations Plan covering the hurricane and flood annexes, prepared for the March 15, 2026 EOP filing. It sets out activation levels, restoration priorities, staging, mutual assistance, emergency generation and communications. The cyber security and physical security annexes are filed separately and are not included.

1. Purpose and filing

Electric utilities must file an emergency operations plan and executive summary with the PUCT by March 15 each year. A transmission and distribution utility's plan must include annexes for hurricanes (with evacuation and re-entry), cyber security, physical security and flooding. This excerpt contains the hurricane and flood annexes.

2. Activation levels

The storm organization uses four activation levels. Level 4 events are managed by the affected district. Level 1 is a system-wide event with more than 100,000 customers out or a forecast hurricane landfall; storm command then runs from the Houston operations center.

Levels 3 and 2 bring in shared crews, contractor and vegetation resources and the overflow contact partner as the expected outage count grows.

3. Restoration priorities

Restoration starts by making downed lines safe and then follows established priorities.

1. Public safety hazards, such as wires down.
2. Registered critical facilities: hospitals, water and wastewater plants and emergency services.
3. Substations and main feeders that serve the most customers.
4. Laterals.
5. Individual services.

4. Critical load and critical care customers

REPs that request disconnection of critical load or critical care customers must coordinate with Sedgewater. During activations the storm command desk keeps the list of registered critical facilities; it does not hold individual customer medical information.

5. Staging and mutual assistance

The plan names four pre-arranged staging sites, one near each district. In the Prairie District the site is County Line Yard.

Sedgewater belongs to a regional mutual assistance group under a standing agreement that sets roles, request procedures and reimbursement. Mutual assistance programs are voluntary partnerships that share crews, equipment and materials.

6. Emergency generation

Sedgewater Electric Delivery leases 36 MW of mobile emergency generation under a lease that ends in 2027. The units are used only to restore power to customers during widespread outages; a utility leasing these facilities may not sell energy or ancillary services from them. Legislation passed in 2025 limits new or renewed leases to rapidly deployable units of 5 MW or less, which will shape the replacement of the current lease.

7. Flood annex

Bayou District has older low-lying suburbs with heavy tree canopy and flood exposure, and parts of Harbor lie along the port corridor. Before forecast heavy rain, districts confirm access routes to staging sites, check substation flood defenses and prepare crews to work from higher ground. After flooding, energized equipment in standing water is made safe before restoration begins.

8. Customer and regulator communications

The contact center targets an average speed of answer of 60 seconds or less in normal operations and under three minutes during storm activation, with abandonment below 5%. For utilities serving more than 200,000 customers, loss of service to 20,000 customers is a significant interruption; if it lasts more than 24 hours, a summary report is due within five working days after service is restored.

9. Drill and lessons from 2025

The plan must be drilled every year, and an entity in a hurricane evacuation zone must test the hurricane annex in at least one drill. The 2026 annual drill is scheduled for May 6, 2026 and will test the hurricane annex, including evacuation and re-entry of staging sites.

The June 11-13, 2025 wind event, which mainly affected Prairie and Bayou, is used as the drill scenario base.